could hope for was a sort of second-class citizenship in which they could live in India only on sufferance.

In 1939 Savarkar wrote the foreword to a book by the Nazi sympathiser and European-born Hindu revivalist who called herself Savitri Devi. Savitri Devi (1905–1982), born Maximiani Portas of mixed Greek, French and English parentage, was a remarkable figure who, among other idiosyncratic beliefs, considered Adolf Hitler an avatar of Vishnu. Her book, prophetically titled *A Warning to the Hindus*, is a passionate polemic about the need for Hindu reassertion. Savitri Devi asserted that, 'Hinduism is the national religion of India, and there is no real India besides Hindu India'. Savarkar joined the author in arguing that:

> 'In all walks of life, for a long time, the Hindus have been fed on inertia-producing thoughts which disabled them to act energetically for any purpose in life, other than "moksha," that is to say escape from this world—where to? God knows. And this is one of the causes of the continuous enslavement of our Hindu Rashtra for centuries altogether'.[7]

Not for Savarkar the abstruse metaphysics of Advaita; what he and Savitri Devi were interested in was political power, here and now. For Savitri Devi, political power, defined as 'the power of law with organised military force' is 'everything in the world… We would like the Hindus to remember this, and to strive to acquire political power at any cost. Social reforms are necessary, not because they will bring more "humanity" among the Hindus, as many think, but because they will bring unity, that is to say power.'[8]

DEFINING NATIONHOOD: GOLWALKAR

This logic was taken even farther by M. S. Golwalkar (1906–1973), the *sarsangchalak* or head of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) for three decades (1940–1973), who supplanted Savarkar as the principal ideologue of Hindu nationalism, notably in his 1939 screed *We, or Our Nationhood Defined*[9] and in the anthology of his writings and speeches, *Bunch of Thoughts*.[10] Golwalkar made it clear that India was the holy land of the Hindus. He writes: 'Hindusthan is the land of the Hindus and is the terra firma for the Hindu nation alone to flourish upon…'[11] According to him, India was a pristine Hindu country in ancient times,[12]